THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

[MSMK7037] [Corporate Communications]

GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor: Clara Shek

Email: clarashe@hku.hk
Personal: clara.shek99@gmail.com
Office: clara.shek@ogilvy.com
Phone: +852-91899920
Consultation time: By appointment

- Dec 12 (Fri), 5:30-6:30pm
- Dec 19 (Fri), 5:30-6:30pm
- Jan 9 (Fri), 5:30-6:30pm
- Jan 16 (Fri), 5:30-6:30pm
- Jan 23 (Fri), 5:30-6:30pm
- Other schedule: By appointment

Teaching Assistant: Lemon Jiang
Email: lemonjsn@hku.hk

Pre-requisites: [N/A]

Reference Book: Cornelissen, J. (2020). Corporate communication: A guide to theory and practice (6th edition). Los Angeles: SAGE.

COURSE DESCRIPTION

It takes years to build a reputation and seconds to destroy it. Protecting an organisation's reputation is considered a mission-critical function and one of the most important strategic skills for business leaders. Given the vulnerability of modern-day brands and organisations and the need to protect and nurture them, Corporate Communications has become an indispensable function.

Developed and conducted by an award-winning industry leader, this Corporate Communications course is designed to provide students with both a strategic framework and hands-on understanding in what it takes to manage an organisation's reputation. Through a combination of case analysis, readings, discussions and scenario responses, students would build essential corporate communications skills relevant to the 21st century world.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

This is a hands-on course designed to build a practical understanding of the role of Corporate Communications and enable students to develop foundation skills on reputation management, stakeholder engagement, media/social media strategy, integrated communications, corporate branding and identity, sustainability and issues/crisis communications.

At the end of the course, students could apply the learning in work situation and would have the practical tips to carry out core corporate communications tasks.

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of the programme discipline

PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge

PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership

PLO4: Developing Global Outlook

PLO5: Mastering communication skills

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Course Learning Outcomes	Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes
CLO1: [Acquire a practical understanding of the Corporate Communications function]	PLO[1]
CLO2: [Gain hands-on knowledge of the diverse scope of Corporate Communications]	PLO[2]
CLO3: [Develop corporate communications foundation skills that could be applied in work situation]	PLO[3]
CLO4: [Develop the ability to apply critical and analytical thinking in assessing international and local corporate communications situations]	PLO[4&5]

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	Expected Hour	Study Load (% of study)
T&L1. Interactive lectures	30	25%
T&L2. Assignments	60	50%
T&L3. Lecture preparation & Self-study	30	25%
Total	120	100%

Assessment Methods	Brief Description (Optional)	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1. In-class participation	Attendance & discussions	30%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
A2. Assignments	Effort and accuracy	40%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
A3. Final Group Project	Effort and accuracy	30%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
	Total	100%	

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

Course Grade Descriptors

A+, A, A-	• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions professionally • High participation in discussions • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Achieve excellent performance in the assignments/presentations with very accurate situation assessment and very good analytical and problem solving skills
B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Good participation in discussions • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Achieve good performance in the assignments/presentations with accurate situation assessment and good analytical and problem solving skills
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions as set • Some participation in discussions • Present arguments in a well-structured manner • Acceptable performance in the assignments/presentations with reasonably accurate situation assessment and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills
D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions as set • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Marginally acceptable performance in the assignments/presentations with some errors in situation assessment and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills

F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the assignments/presentations with major errors in the situation assessment and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills
Assessment Rubrics for Participation	
A+, A, A-	• High participation in discussions • Always attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions professionally • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
B+, B, B-	• Good participation in discussions • Often attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
C+, C, C-	• Some participation in discussions • Sometimes attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions as set • Present arguments in a well-structured manner • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
D+, D	• Minimal or no participation in discussions • Rarely attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions as set • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
F	• Minimal or no participation in discussions • Almost never attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Present arguments poorly • Behave poorly in class (often chatting with others, using cell phones, or being late)
Assessment Rubrics for Assignments and Presentations	
A+, A, A-	• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Achieve excellent performance in the assignments/presentations with very accurate situation assessment and very good analytical and problem solving skills
B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Achieve good performance in the assignments/presentations with accurate situation assessment and good analytical and problem solving skills
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the assignments/presentations with reasonably accurate situation assessment and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills
D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the assignments/presentations with some errors in the situation assessment and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the assignments/presentations with major errors in the situation assessment and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

Course schedule is subject to change as instructor deems appropriate and necessary.

Students are requested to complete the assigned reading before the class.

Dec 9 (Tues) 18:30-21:30
Class #1 Introduction to Corporate Communications
Reading: Cornelissen, J. (2020). Corporate communication: A guide to theory and practice (6th edition). Los Angeles: SAGE. Chapter 1: Defining Corporate Communication, 1.1-1.4

Dec 12 (Fri) 18:30-21:30
Class #2 Corporate Reputation Management
Reading: Cornelissen, J. (2020). Corporate communication: A guide to theory and practice (6th edition). Los Angeles: SAGE. Chapter 6: Communication Strategy and Strategic Planning, 6.1-6.5; Chapter 7: Research and Measurement. 7.1-7.6

Dec 16 (Tues) 18:30-21:30
Class #3 Stakeholder Engagement
Reading: Cornelissen, J. (2020). Corporate communication: A guide to theory and practice (6th edition). Los Angeles: SAGE. Chapter 4: Stakeholder Management and Communication, 4.1-4.6

Dec 19 (Fri) 14:00-17:00
Class #4 Media Relations & Social Media
Reading: Cornelissen, J. (2020). Corporate communication: A guide to theory and practice (6th edition). Los Angeles: SAGE. Chapter 3: Corporate Communication in a Changing Media Environment, 3.1-3.4; Chapter 8: Media Relations, 8.1-8.5.

Dec 19 (Fri) 18:30-21:30
Class #5 Students' Presentation of Assignment #1
No assigned reading

Jan 6 (Tues) 18:30-21:30
Class #6 Integrated Communications
Reading: Cornelissen, J. (2020). Corporate communication: A guide to theory and practice (6th edition). Los Angeles: SAGE. Chapter 2: Corporate Communication in Contemporary Organizations, 2.1-2.5

Jan 9 (Fri) 18:30-21:30
Class #7 Corporate Branding & Identity
Reading: Cornelissen, J. (2020). Corporate communication: A guide to theory and practice (6th edition). Los Angeles: SAGE. Chapter 5: Corporate Identity, Branding and Corporate Reputation, 5.1-5.5

Jan 13 (Tues) 18:30-21:30
Class #8 Corporate Social Responsibility & Sustainability
Reading: Cornelissen, J. (2020). Corporate communication: A guide to theory and practice (6th edition). Los Angeles: SAGE. Chapter 13: Corporate Social Responsibility and Community Relations, 13.1-13.5

Jan 16 (Fri) 18:30-21:30
Class #9 Issues/Crises Communications
Reading: Cornelissen, J. (2020). Corporate communication: A guide to theory and practice (6th edition). Los Angeles: SAGE. Chapter 10: Issues Management, 10.1-10.6; Chapter 11: Crisis Communication, 11.1-11.6

Jan 23 (Fri) 18:30-21:30
Class #10 Students' Final Group Project Presentation
No assigned reading

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS (e.g. journals, textbooks, website addresses etc.)

See above list for each class. Additional reading/case studies to be announced on Moodle.

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

- ○ Online response via Moodle site
- ○ Others: ___SFTL_____ (please specify)

COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

An orderly learning environment is extremely important for this course. Disruptive behaviors are absolutely unacceptable. Academic dishonesty includes cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, falsifying academic records, and any act designed to avoid participating honestly in the learning process. Any such dishonesty will result in an F grade.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)

Assignments will be submitted in class before the lectures. No late assignment will be accepted.
Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded on Moodle.